

sometimes. As athletes, we get injured pretty often. We'll get back stronger by the end of it.

Women's doubles is arguably the toughest among the five categories. The rallies can go up to 100-150 shots. How difficult is it to manage fitness?

Treesa: Physically, it is demanding. If it is a good match, it can easily go past 90 minutes. When we both started playing at that level, it was very difficult for us to play the rally games. But now, we are fighting with the Asian players and we have improved our strength in these four years.

Gayatri: Initially, it was a bit challenging. If we are playing against a top pair, it's going to be 90 minutes at least. You can't expect anything less. But we are giving them a fight at this point.

You've had close battles with World No. 1s Liu Sheng Shu and Tan Ning, even though they lead 6-1. What makes this matchup so compelling?

Gayatri: The first time we played against them at the Badminton Asia Mixed Team Championships in 2023, we beat them. After that, we've lost a few times. Even at the Swiss Open (semifinals) this year, we won the first set.

Both of us were confident that we could take the second set but it just didn't go our way. Also, the Chinese pair has a different game compared to the usual women's doubles. It is more like men's doubles. They are more powerful as well.

Treesa: At the Swiss Open, we could have won that match. I think it was the best match we played. Almost 90 minutes. Strength-wise, we need to accept that they are better than us, but if we



WE NEED TO ACCEPT THAT THE CALENDAR IS HARD. WE NEED TO BE VERY CHOOSY ABOUT THE TOURNAMENTS WE PLAY. IT IS THE SAME FOR EVERYONE. THAT'S THE REALITY WE NEED TO ACCEPT – TREESA